"Not at all," I said, offended. "I like the name."

And every time after that, this man who loved my bravery called me nothing but "Zack," a nickname I despised.

While at Breadloaf, I got a call from Fred Pohl, who told me that

5 By then the Americans were on the offensive in Korea and it was clear we were not going to suffer the humiliation of being pushed into the sea.

Horace Gold had seen what there was of The Stars, like Dust— and wanted to serialize it in his magazine, which he was calling Galaxy Science Fiction. He assured me that Brad would approve (but I worried about Campbell—and then decided not to, since Astounding was filled with dianetics for issue after issue at this time).

The only catch was that Horace wanted me to introduce a new element of suspense. Everyone would have to be looking for a mysterious document, which would turn out at the very end to be a copy of the United States Constitution.

I objected very strongly to that, saying it was corny and downright unbelievable. No one could suppose that an instrument of government suitable for a primitive nation forming a small part of a single world would be suitable for a stellar federation. Fred soothed me and said that I could explain that the document was merely an inspiration. It would satisfy Horace and I could take it out for book publication.

So I agreed, but when I told Brad, apologetically, that I would have to add this for Horace's sake, he said, "That sounds great. We'll keep it in the book version, too." And he did, which is the chief reason why The Stars, like Dust — is my least favorite novel.

The faculty at Breadloaf recognized my established-writer status and didn't lump me together with the other students. Bill Sloane, without warning, called me to speak on the nonhuman heroes of science fiction and I gave a one-minute impromptu speech that went over well.

Then, on August 26, I helped out in the session that was designed to teach interviewing by allowing myself to serve as the subject of an interview. I was told by the faculty to answer briefly, and to interpret questions narrowly and literally, so that the students would learn how to ask questions properly.